often speak of the *political liberties* of Europe, or the nations of Europe.

5. *Religious liberty*, is the free right of adopting and enjoying opinions on religious subjects, and of worshiping the Supreme Being according to the dictates of conscience, without external control.

6. *Liberty*, in metaphysics, as opposed to *necessity*, is the power of an agent to do or forbear any particular action, according to the determination or thought of the mind, by which either is preferred to the other. *Locke.*

Freedom of the will; exemption from compulsion or restraint in willing or volition.

7. Privilege; exemption; immunity enjoyed by prescription or by grant; with a plural. Thus we speak of the *liberties* of the commercial cities of Europe.

8. Leave; permission granted. The witness obtained *liberty* to leave the court.

9. A space in which one is permitted to pass without restraint, and beyond which he may not lawfully pass; with a plural; as the *liberties* of a prison.

10. Freedom of action or speech beyond the ordinary bounds of civility or decorum. Females should repel all improper *liberties*.

To take the liberty to do or say any thing, to use freedom not specially granted.

To set at liberty, to deliver from confinement; to release from restraint.

To be at liberty, to be free from restraint.

Liberty of the press, is freedom from any restriction on the power to publish books; the free power of publishing what one pleases, subject only to punishment for abusing the privilege, or publishing what is mischievous to the public or injurious to individuals. *Blackstone.*

LIB'IDINIST, *n.* One given to lewdness. *Junius.*

LIBID'INOUS, *a.* [L. *libidinosus*, from *libido*, *lubido*, lust, from *libeo*, *libet*, *lubet*, to please, it pleaseth; G. *liebe*, love; *lieben*, to love; Eng. *love*, which see. The root is *lib* or *lub*.]

Lustful; lewd; having an eager appetite for venereal pleasure. *Bentley.*

LIBID'INOUSLY, *a.* Lustfully; with lewd desire.

LIBID'INOUSNESS, *n.* The state or quality of being lustful; inordinate appetite for venereal pleasure.

LI'BRA, *n.* [L.] The balance; the seventh sign in the zodiac, which the sun enters at the autumnal equinox, in September.

LIBRA'RIAN, *n.* [L. *librarius*, with a different signification, from *liber*, bark, a book.]

1. The keeper or one who has the care of a library or collection of books.

2. One who transcribes or copies books. [*Not now used.*] *Broome.*

LI'BRARY, *n.* [L. *librarium*, *libraria*, from *liber*, a book.]

1. A collection of books belonging to a private person, or to a public institution or a company.

2. An edifice or an apartment for holding a collection of books.

LI'BRATE, *v. t.* [L. *libro*, from *libra*, a balance, a level; allied perhaps to Eng. *level*.]

To poise; to balance; to hold in equipoise.

LI'BRATE, *v. i.* To move, as a balance; to be poised.

Their parts all *librate* on too nice a beam. *Clifton.*

LIBRA'TION, *n.* The act of balancing or state of being balanced; a state of equipoise, with equal weights on both sides of a center.

2. In *astronomy*, an apparent irregularity of the moon's motions, by which it seems to librate about its axis. *Encyc.*

Libration is the balancing motion or trepidation in the firmament, whereby the declination of the sun and the latitude of the stars change from time to time. *Dict. Trev.*

3. A balancing or equipoise between extremes. *Darwin.*

LI'BRATORY, *a.* Balancing; moving like a balance, as it tends to an equipoise or level.

LICE, *plu.* of *louse*.

LICE-BANE, *n.* A plant.

LI'CENSE, *n.* [Fr. from L. *licentia*, from *liceo*, to be permitted, Ir. *leighim*, *ligim*, to allow or permit.]

1. Leave; permission; authority or liberty given to do or forbear any act. A *license* may be verbal or written; when *written*, the paper containing the authority is called a *license*. A man is not permitted to retail spirituous liquors till he has obtained a *license*.

2. Excess of liberty; exorbitant freedom; freedom abused, or used in contempt of law or decorum.

License they mean, when they cry liberty. *Milton.*

LI'CENSE, *v. t.* To permit by grant of authority; to remove legal restraint by a grant of permission; as, to *license* a man to keep an inn.

2. To authorize to act in a particular character; as, to *license* a physician or a lawyer.

3. To dismiss. [*Not in use.*] *Wotton.*

LI'CENSER, *n.* One who grants permission; a person authorized to grant permission to others; as a *licenser* of the press.

LICEN'TIATE, *n.* [from L. *licentia.*] One who has a license; as a *licentiate* in physic or medicine.

2. In *Spain*, one who has a degree; as a *licentiate* in law or divinity. The officers of justice are mostly distinguished by this title. *Encyc.*

LICEN'TIATE, *v. t.* To give license or permission. *L'Estrange.*

LICEN'TIOUS, *a.* [L. *licentiosus.*] Using license; indulging freedom to excess; unrestrained by law or morality; loose; dissolute; as a *licentious* man.

2. Exceeding the limits of law or propriety; wanton; unrestrained; as *licentious* desires. *Licentious* thoughts precede *licentious* conduct.

LICEN'TIOUSLY, *adv.* With excess of liberty; in contempt of law and morality.

LICEN'TIOUSNESS, *n.* Excessive indulgence of liberty; contempt of the just restraints of law, morality and decorum. The *licentiousness* of authors is justly condemned; the *licentiousness* of the press is punishable by law.

Law is the god of wise men; *licentiousness* is the god of fools. *Plato.*

LICH, *a.* [Sax. *lic.* See *Like.*] Like; even; equal. *Obs.* *Gower.*

LICH, *n.* [Sax. *lic* or *lice*, a body, the flesh, a dead body or corpse; *lichama*, a living body; hence *lichwake*, watching with the dead; *Lichfield*, the field of dead bodies; Goth. *leik*, the flesh, a body; *leikan*, to please, Sax. *licean*; Goth. *leiks*, like; G. *gleich*, D. *lyk* and *gelyk*, like; G. *leiche*, a dead body, D. *lyk*; Heb. חלק chalak, smooth; Ar. خلق chalaka, to shave, to make smooth; خلق galaka, to measure, to form, to create, to make smooth and equable, to be beautiful; derivatives, creature, man, people. We see the radical sense is smooth, or rather to make even, equal, smooth; hence like, likeness, and a body. We have here an instance of the radical sense of *man* and *body*, almost exactly analogous to that of *Adam*, from דמה to make equal, to be like.]

LICH'EN, *n.* [L. from Gr. λειχην.] In *botany*, the name for an extensive division of cryptogamian plants, constituting a genus in the order of Algæ, in the Linnean system, but now forming a distinct natural order. They appear in the form of thin flat crusts, covering rocks and the bark of trees, or in foliaceous expansions, or branched like a shrub in miniature, or sometimes only as a gelatinous mass, or a powdery substance. They are called rock moss and tree moss, and some of the liverworts are of this order. They also include the Iceland moss and the reindeer moss; but they are entirely distinct from the true mosses *(Musci.)* *Ed. Encyc.*

2. In *surgery*, a species of impetigo, appearing in the form of a red, dry, rough, and somewhat prurient spot, that gives off small furfuraceous scales. *Hooper.*

LICHENOGRAPH'IC, LICHENOGRAPH'ICAL, *a.* Pertaining to lichenography.

LICHENOG'RAPHIST, *n.* One who describes the lichens.

LICHENOG'RAPHY, *n.* [*lichen* and γραφω, to write.]

A description of the vegetables called lichens; the science which illustrates the natural history of the lichens. *Acharius.*

LIC'IT, *a.* [L. *licitus.*] Lawful.

LIC'ITLY, *adv.* Lawfully.

LIC'ITNESS, *n.* Lawfulness.

LICK, *v. t.* [Sax. *liccian*; Goth. *laigwan*; G. *lecken*, *schlecken*; D. *likken*; Dan. *likker*, *slikker*; Sw. *slekia*, *slikia*; Fr. *lecher*; It. *leccare*; Ir. *leagaim*, *lighim*; Russ. *lokayu*, *liju*; L. *lingo*; Gr. λειχω. Class Lg. No. 12. 18. See *Like* and *Sleek*.]

1. To pass or draw the tongue over the surface; as, a dog *licks* a wound. *Temple.*

2. To lap; to take in by the tongue; as, a dog or cat *licks* milk. 1 Kings xxi.

To lick up, to devour; to consume entirely.

Now shall this company *lick up* all that are round about us, as an ox *licketh up* the grass of the field. Numb. xxii.

To lick the dust, to be slain; to perish in battle.

His enemies shall *lick the dust*. Ps. lxxii.